Notes for MAT267

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Chapter 1

Solving Simple ODEs

Chapter 2

Existence and Uniqueness of Solutions

2.1 Introduction

In this chapter, our biggest goal is to investigate the existence and uniqueness of solutions to an ODE.

2.2 Basic Notions

2.2.1 Continuity

Consider the setting $E \subset \mathbb{R}^n$ and $f : E \to \mathbb{R}^m$

Definition 1. *We say that f is continuous at a point $a \in E$ if it satisfies:*

$$\forall \varepsilon > 0 \quad \exists \delta > 0 \quad \forall x \in E \quad (|x - a| < \delta \implies |f(x) - f(a)| < \epsilon)$$

Definition 2. *Alternatively, we say a function $f : E \to \mathbb{R}^m$ is uniformly continuous on a set $D \subset E$*

$$\forall \varepsilon > 0 \quad \exists \delta > 0 \quad \forall x, y \in D \quad (|x - y| < \delta \implies |f(x) - f(y)| < \varepsilon)$$

See that we can say a function is continuous on $D \subset E$ if it is continuous in each point on D, but that doesn't necessarity satisfy uniform continuity on E as they might not be a "global" bound on the domain such that the ε bounds the range.

We can take this "global" bound concept further to a family of functions:

Definition 3. *We call a possibly infinite family of function $\mathcal{F} \subset \{f : E \to \mathbb{R}^m\}$* ***equicontinuous*** *on $D \subset \mathbb{R}^m$ if*

$$\forall \varepsilon > 0 \quad \exists \delta > 0 \quad \forall f \in \mathcal{F} \quad \forall x, y \in E \quad (|x - y| < \delta \implies |f(x) - f(y)| < \varepsilon)$$

for any $x, y \in D$.

In other words, a set of functions that is equicontinous on D must have functions that are individually uniformly continuous, and also for each ε, the set of δ satisfing ε for $f \in \mathcal{F}$ must have a non-zero infimum.

2.2.1.1 Examples

a

2.2.2 Uniform Convergence

We define a norm on functions:

Definition 4. *The Uniform Norm is defined for a function $f : E \to \mathbb{R}^m$:*

$$\|f\|_\infty = \sup_{x \in E} f(x)$$

and a type of convergence of a sequence of functions

Definition 5. *For a sequence of functions $f_n : E \to \mathbb{R}^m$, we say that the sequence of functions converges uniformly to $f : E \to \mathbb{R}^m$ if*

$$\forall \varepsilon > 0 \quad \exists N > 0 \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N} \quad \forall x \in E \quad (n > N \implies |f_n(x) - f(x)| < \varepsilon)$$

We denote this as

$$f_n \rightrightarrows f$$

This can be easily interpreted as a improvement of the natural form of convergence, which provides possibly varying δ_x to satisfy ε for each $x \in E$. There are many implications of Uniform convergence of a sequence of function.

Theorem 1. *If $f_n, f : E \to \mathbb{R}^m$ and each f_n is continuous on E, then f is continuous.*

Proof.

$$\|f(x) - f(a)\| \leq \|f_n(x) - f(x)\| - \|f_n(x) - f_n(a)\| - \|f_n(a) - f(a)\| < 3\varepsilon$$

by choosing n and δ. □

Theorem 2. *Let E be a compact subset of $\mathbb{R}^n$, $f_n \in C(E, \mathbb{R}^m)$. If $f_n \rightrightarrows f$ for some f, then*

1. *$\{f_n\}$ is equicontinuous*

2. *$\{f_n\}$ is uniformly bounded in the uniform norm, that is*

$$\exists M \in \mathbb{R}^+ \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N} \quad (\|f_n\|_\infty \leq M)$$

2.2.3 Ascoli-Arzela

Theorem 3. *If E is a compact subset of $\mathbb{R}^n$ and some infinite family $\mathcal{F} \subset C(E, \mathbb{R}^m)$. If $\mathcal{F}$ is equicontinous and unformly bounded, then for every sequence in $\mathcal{F}$ there is a convergent subsequence.*

Proof. Not required. □

2.2.4 Relative Compactness

Definition 6. *Let K be a compact subset of $\mathbb{R}^n$. A set $A \subset C(K, \mathbb{R}^m)$ is called* ***relatively compact*** *if $\overline{A}$ is compact. That is to be said, if A is a metric space, every sequence in A has a convergent subsequence.*

Theorem 4. *If K is a compact subset of $\mathbb{R}^n$ and $A \subseteq C(K, \mathbb{R}^m)$, then A is relatively compact if and only if*

1. *A is equicontinuous*

2. *A is uniformly bounded*

Proof. $\Longrightarrow$
If A is relatively compact, then we know that every sequence has a convergent subsequence under the unform norm. In addition, $\overline{A}$ is compact, thus A is bounded by the uniform norm. If $\mathcal{F}$ is not equicontinuous, then for some $\varepsilon > 0$ and any selection of $\delta > 0$ there is a $f \in \mathcal{F}$ such that $\|f(x) - f(y)\| < \varepsilon$ is not satisfied by $\|x - y\| < \delta$.

$$\|f(x) - f(y)\| \geq \varepsilon$$

But recall that every sequence has a converging subsequence. Consider an converging sequence of such f

$$f_k \rightrightarrows g$$

We know that g must be uniformly continuous as g is continuous on a compact set. Thus, for all $\frac{1}{3}\varepsilon > 0$ there must exist a $\delta > 0$ such that $\|x - y\| < \delta$

$$\|g(x) - g(y)\| < \frac{\varepsilon}{3}$$

Since f_k converges uniformly to g, there must be a $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $k > m$ means that

$$\|f_k(x) - g(x)\| < \frac{\varepsilon}{3}$$

Then,

$$\|f_k(x) - f_k(y)\| < \varepsilon$$

for $k > N$ and $\|x - y\| < \delta$ which contraducts the assumption that $\|f(x) - f(x)\| \geq \varepsilon$ for some ε, x, y where $\|x - y\| < \delta$ for any δ.
$\Leftarrow$
If equicontinuous and uniformly bounded, then by Ascoli-Arzela every sequence has a convergent subsequence, thus A is relatively compact by definition. $\square$

2.2.4.1 Radial Extention

Lemma 1. *Let $f : \overline{\mathbb{B}}(0, R) \subset \mathbb{R}^n \to \mathbb{R}$ be continuous, then we can extend the ball to the entire domain $\mathbb{R}^n$ by defining $F : \mathbb{R}^n \to \mathbb{R}^m$ by*

$$F(x) = \begin{cases} f(x), & \|x\| \leq R \\ f(\frac{x}{\|x\|}), & \|x\| > R \end{cases}$$

Then F is continuous on $\mathbb{R}^n$ and extends f.

2.3 Fixed Point Theorems

2.3.1 Banach's Contraction Mapping Theorem

Theorem 5 (Banach's Contraction Mapping theorem)**.** *Let (D, d) be a complete metric space and $T : D \to D$ be a string contraction, that is,*

$$\exists q \in (0, 1) \quad \forall x, y \in D \quad (d(T(x), T(y)) \leq d(x, y)$$

*Then T has a **unique** fixed point in D.*

Proof. We use Picard's Iteration to solve the problem. Define the iteration

$$x(n) = T(x_{n-1})$$

and let $x_0 \in D$ be arbitary. We first want to show that this sequence converges to some $x^* \in D$. See that

$$d(x_{n+1}, x_n) \leq d(T(x_n), T(x_{n-1})) \leq qd(x_n, x_{n-1}) \leq q^n d(x_1, x_0)$$

thus we have that

$$d(x_n, x_m) \leq \sum_{i=n}^{m-1} d(x_{i+1}, x_i) \leq d(x_1, x_0) \sum_{i=n}^{m-1} q^i$$

Since

$$\sum_{i=n}^{m} q^i \leq \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} q^i - \sum_{i=1}^{n} q^i = \frac{1}{1-q} - S_n$$

Since $\lim_{n\to\infty} S_n = \frac{1}{1-q}$, we have that

$$\forall \varepsilon > 0 \quad \exists N > 0 \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N} \quad (n > N \implies \sum_{i=n}^{m} q^i \leq \frac{1}{1-q} - S_n < \varepsilon)$$

Thus x_n is cauchy, and as D is complete, it must converge to some x^* in D. We verify that x^* is a fixed point:

$$d(T(x^*), x^*) \leq d(T(x^*), T(x_k)) + d(x_k, x^*) \leq (q+1)d(x^*, x_k) < \varepsilon$$

Where ε can be made arbitarily small by selection of k by convergence. Thus,

$$T(x^*) = x^*$$

We now want to show uniqueness. This can be done the same way:

$$d(x^*, y^*) = d(T(x^*), T(y^*)) \leq qd(x^*, y^*)$$

Thus

$$d(x^*, y^*) = 0$$

Then $x^* = y^*$ □

2.3.2 Schauder-Tychonoff Theorem

We begin by constructing a necessary tool:

Theorem 6 (Brouwer's Fixed Point Theorem)**.** *Let $B = \overline{B}(0,1)$ be a closed unit ball of $\mathbb{R}^n$ and $T : B \to B$ be continuous. Then T has atleast one fixed point in B.*

Proof. The proof is not required. □

Now we proceed to the actuall theorem

Theorem 7 (Schauder-Tychonoff Fixed Point Theorem)**.** *Let $E = C([0,1], \mathbb{R}^n)$ and $(E, \|\cdot\|)$ a Banach Space. Let B be the unit ball of E:*

$$B = \{f \in E : \|f\| \leq 1\}$$

Assume that $T : B \to B$ is continuous with respect to the uniform norm and $T(B)$ relatively compact in E, then T has a fixed point in B.

Proof. We wish to use picard's iteration again: construct a suitable sequence that converges to the fixed point. We construct this sequence by linear interpolation:

For each $k \in \mathbb{N}$, pick $a_0, a_1, \cdots, a_k \in \overline{B}(0,1) \subset \mathbb{R}^n$. Define a function

$$x_k : [0,1] \to \mathbb{R}^n$$

such that for $j \in \mathbb{N}$ and $j \leq k$, $t \in [\frac{j-1}{k}, \frac{j}{k}]$:

$$x_k(t) = a_{j-1} + (a_j - a_{j-1})(t - \frac{j-1}{k})$$

then $x_k(\frac{i}{k}) = a_i$ and x_k is continuous. And since $||a_k|| \leq 1$ inside the closed ball of radius 1, and $x_k(t)$ consists of points defined on lines between a_k's, $x_k([0,1])$ is bounded by $\overline{B}(0,1) \subset \mathbb{R}^n$, thus $x_k \in B$.
Let B_k denote the set of all x_k (with arbitary selection of a_j), with the map:

$$P_k(a_0, \cdots, a_k) = x_k \in B_k, \quad x_k(\frac{i}{k}) = a_i$$

P_k is continuous as a small change in a_i corresponds to a small change in x_k due to stability of linear interpolation. Now let

$$T_k(a_0, \cdots, a_k) = (T(P_k(a_0, \cdots, a_k)(\frac{0}{k}), \cdots, T(P_k(a_0, \cdots, a_k))(\frac{k}{k}))$$

Then T_k is continuous by investigating each component, with

$$||T \circ P_k(a)(\frac{i}{k}) - T \circ P_k(b)(\frac{i}{k})|| \leq \|T \circ P_k(a) - T \circ P_k(b)\|_\infty$$

where continuity follows from continuity under uniform norm. Thus, $T_k : \overline{B}(0,1)^{k+1} \to \overline{B}(0,1)^{k+1}$, and is continuious, where $\overline{B}(0,1)^k$ is homoemorphic to $\overline{B}(0,1) \subset \mathbb{R}^{n(k+1)}$. Thus, apply Brouwer's Fixed Point Theorem. Then, there is a fixed point $a^* = (a_0^*, \cdots, a_k^*)$ of T_k, where

$$T_k(a^*) = (a_0^*, \cdots, a_k^*), \quad T(P_k(a^*))(\frac{i}{k}) = P_k(a^*)(\frac{i}{k}) = a_i^*$$

Then we have a partially fixed point $x_k^* = P^k(a^*)$, for which $Tx_k^* = x_k^*$ for the interpolated points a^*. Construct a sequence of such $(T(x_k^*))_{k\in\mathbb{N}}$. See that since $T(x_k^*) \in T(B)$ is relatively compact, there is a convergent subsequence converging by the uniform norm to some $x^* \in B$. Index this sequence by x_k.

We want to show that $\|T(x_k) - x_k\|_\infty \to 0$. That is, we need to show that

$$\forall \varepsilon > 0 \quad \exists N > 0 \quad \forall x \in [0,1] \quad (k > N \implies \|Tx_k - x_k\|_\infty < \varepsilon)$$

See that

$$\|Tx_k - x_k\| = \sup_{t\in[0,1]} \|T(x_k)(t) - x_k(t)\|$$

Then by triangle inequality for $t \in [\frac{i-1}{k}, \frac{i}{k}]$:

$$\|Tx_k(t) - x_k(t)\| \leq \left\|Tx_k(t) - Tx_k(\frac{i}{k})\right\| + \left\|Tx_k(\frac{i}{k}) - x_k(\frac{i}{k})\right\| + \left\|x_k(\frac{i}{k}) - x_k(t)\right\|$$

Let $\varepsilon > 0$. Since $T(B)$ is relatively compact, it must be equicontinuous. Thus, there is a *delta* > 0 such that $\|x - y\| < \delta \implies \|Tx_k(x) - Tx_k(y)\| < \frac{\varepsilon}{2}$. Then choose N large enough such that $\frac{1}{k} < \delta$.
Also see that $||x_k(\frac{i}{k} - x_k(t)|| \leq \left\|x_k(\frac{i}{k}) - x_k(\frac{i-1}{k})\right\| = \left\|Tx_k(\frac{i}{k}) - Tx_k(\frac{i-1}{k})\right\|$.

Then, if $k > N$,

$$\|Tx_k(t) - x_k(t)\| < \varepsilon$$

for all $t \in [\frac{i-1}{k}, \frac{i}{k}]$, and N independent of i, this is true for all $t \in [0,1]$. Then,

$$x_k \rightrightarrows x^*$$

To verify that this is indeed a fixed point,

$$T(x^*) = T(\lim_{k\to\infty} x_k) = \lim_{k\to\infty} T(x_k) = x^*$$

And thus x^* is a fixed point in B

□

2.4 Existence of Solutions

Definition 7 (The Global Cauchy Problem)**.** *Let $t_0 < t_1$ in $\mathbb{R}$ and*

$$f : [t_0, t_1] \times \mathbb{R}^n \to \mathbb{R}^n$$

together with an inital value $x_0 \in \mathbb{R}^n$. The initial value problem is :

$$\begin{cases} x'(t) = f(t, x(t)), & t \in [t_0, t_1] \\ x(t_0) = x_) \end{cases}$$

where we seek a function $x \in C^1([t_0, t_1], \mathbb{R}^n$ if possible.

Definition 8 (Intergral Equation for an IVP)**.** *Given f and x_0 as above, the intergral equation is given by*

$$x(t) = x_0 + \int_{t_0}^{t} f(s, x(s))\mathrm{d}s$$

A solution solves the IVP if and only if it satisfies the Integral Equation.

With this as motivation, we define the picard map :

Definition 9. *For (f, x_0, t_0, t_1) as previously defined, the picard map for the IVP is given by:*

$$T(x) = x_0 + \int_{t_0}^{t} f(s, x(s))\mathrm{d}s$$

Then the solution to the IVP is exactly the fixed points of T.

and with these definitions, we have our first theorem for existence of solution

2.4.1 Cauchy-Peano existence Theorem

Theorem 8 (Cauchy-Peano Existence)**.** *Consider a global cauchy problem as defined with (f, x_0, t_0, t_1) . If f is continuous and bounded, then the IVP has at least one solution on $[t_0, t_1]$)*

There are two main ways to prove this:

2.4.1.1 Proof 1

Proof. Consider Banach Space $C([t_0, t_1])$ with the supremum norm. Let

$$B = \{x \in C([t_0, t_1], \mathbb{R}^n) : \|x\|_\infty \leq 1\}$$

Define the Picard Map:

$$Tx = x_0 + \int_{t_0}^{t_1} f(s, x(s))\mathrm{d}s$$

We wish to find a fixed point of T on B. The idea is to use the Schauder-Tychonoff theorem. Thus we need to show that T is continuous and $T(B)$ is relatively compact.

To show that T is continuous. It is sufficient to show that any uniformly convergent sequence $(x_k) \rightrightarrows x$ means that $(T(x_k)) \rightrightarrows T(x)$, that is if $x_k \to x$, then

$$||T(x_k) - T(x)||_\infty = \sup_{t\in[t_0,t_1]} \|T(x_k)(t) - T(x)(t)\|$$

Thus,

$$\begin{aligned}\|T(x_k)(t) - T(x)(t)\| &\leq \left\| \int_{t_0}^{t} f(s, x_k(s)) - f(s, x(s))\mathrm{d}s \right\| \\ &\leq (t_1 - t_0) \sup_{s\in[t_0,t_1]} ||f(s, x_k(s)) - f(s, x(s))||\end{aligned}$$

but since f is continuous at x, there exists $N > 0$ such that $k > N$ means that $\|f(x_k) - f(x)\| < \epsilon$. Then $\|T(x_k) - T(x)\|_\infty < \varepsilon$ up to choice of N, thus it is continuous.
Now we want to show that it $T(B)$ is relatively compact, that is , $T(B)$ is uniformly bounded and equicontinuous. See that

$$\begin{aligned}||T(x)(t)|| &= ||x_0|| + \int_{t_0}^{t} ||f(s, x(s))||\mathrm{d}s \\ &\leq ||x_0|| + M(t_1 - t_0)\end{aligned}$$

Thus is uniformly bounded. With

$$H = \|x_0\| + M(t_1 - t_0)$$

To show equicontinuity, consider

$$\begin{aligned}\|T(x)(t) - T(x)(t')\| &= \int_{t'}^{t} \|f(s, x(s))\|\mathrm{d}s \\ &\leq M|t - t'|\end{aligned}$$

Then T is equicontinuous since the bound is independent of x. Now consider two cases:
$H \leq 1$
Then we may directly apply Schauder-Tychonoff as $T : B \to B$. Since T is equicontinuous and uniformly bounded, it is relativaly compact. Thus, by Schauder - Tychonoff, there is a fixed point $x^* : [t_0, t_1] \to \mathbb{R}^n$ a solution to the IVP.

$H > 1$
Then we scale :

$$y_0 = x_0 \quad g(t, y(t)) = \frac{1}{H} f(t, Hx(t)), \quad \text{set} x(t) = Hy(t)$$

Then Schauder-Tychonoff follows similarly. □

2.4.1.2 Proof 2

2.4.2 Picard-Lindelof Existence

Theorem 9 (Picard-Lindelof Theorem)**.** *Let $D \subset \mathbb{R} \times \mathbb{R}^n$ be open, and $(x_0, y_0) \in D$, $f : D \to \mathbb{R}^n$. Assume:*

1. *f is continuous in the first arguement*
2. *f is Lipschitz in the second variable by constant K on D*

Then there exists $a > 0$ such that the IVP

$$\begin{cases} y'(x) = f(x, y(x)) \\ y(x_0) = y_0 \end{cases}$$

has a solution on $[x_0 - a, x_0 + a]$. Further, the solution is unique on that interval. That is to say, any solution defined on the interval must agree with y for the entire interval.

2.4.2.1 Proof via Picard Iteration

2.4.2.2 Proof via Banach's Contraction Mapping Theorem

Proof. Choose a closed rectangle on the domain of f:

$$R' = [x_0 - A, x_0 + A] \times [y_0 - L, y_0 + L]$$

Recall that f is continuous, thus it is uniformly continuous and bounded on the compact set R'. Let

$$|f(x, y)| \leq M$$

for any $(x, y) \in R'$. Define length

$$a \leq A, \quad a \leq \frac{L}{M}, \quad aK < 1$$

Then let $I = [x_0 - a, x_0 + a]$, we have the complete metric space

$$X = \{y \in C(I, \mathbb{R}^n); |y(x_0) - y_0| \leq L\}$$

, complete as it is closed. We want to show that the picard map

$$T(y) = y_0 + \int_{x_0}^{x} f(s, y(s))\mathrm{d}s$$

is a strict contranction from X to X, and thus there is a unique solution on the interval I.
Let $y \in X$, then

$$\|T(y)(x) - y_0\| \leq \int_{x_0}^{x} f(s, y(s))\mathrm{d}s \leq aM \leq L$$

thus $Ty \in X$, thus $T : X \to X$.

$$\begin{aligned}\|T(y_1)(t) - T(y_2)(t)\| &= \left\| \int_{x_0}^{x} f(s, y_1(s)) - f(s, y_2(s))\mathrm{d}s \right\| \\ &\leq |x - x_0|K||x_1 - x_2||_\infty\end{aligned}$$

thus

$$\|T(y_1) - T(y_2)\|_\infty \leq Ka\|y_1 - y_2\|_\infty$$

and recall that $0 < aK < 1$, T is a strict contraction on X. Then, there exists a unique fixed point of T the picard map on X, and thus the fixed point y^* is the unique solution for the IVP. □

2.5 Uniqueness Theorems

2.5.1 Picard-Lindelof Uniqueness

Theorem 10 (Picard-Lindelof Theorem)**.** *Let $D \subset \mathbb{R} \times \mathbb{R}^n$ be open, and $(x_0, y_0) \in D$, $f : D \to \mathbb{R}^n$. Assume:*

1. *f is continuous in the first arguement*
2. *f is Lipschitz in the second variable by constant K on D*

Then there exists $a > 0$ such that the IVP

$$\begin{cases} y'(x) = f(x, y(x)) \\ y(x_0) = y_0 \end{cases}$$

has a solution on $[x_0 - a, x_0 + a]$. Further, the solution is unique on that interval. That is to say, any solution defined on the interval must agree with y for the entire interval.

2.5.1.1 Proof I, Iterated Picard Style Estimates

2.5.1.2 Proof II, Gronwall's Inequality

2.5.2 Osgood's Uniqueness Theorem

2.6 Gronwall's Inequality

Theorem 11 (Gronwall's Inequality Integral Form)**.** *Let $F : [a, b] \to \mathbb{R}$ and $G : [a, b] \to [0, \infty)$ be continuous. Suppose $y : [a, b] \to \mathbb{R}$ continuous and satisfies*

$$y(t) \leq F(t) + \int_a^t G(s)y(s)\mathrm{d}s, \quad \forall t \in [a, b]$$

Then for every $t \in [a, b]$,

$$y(t) \leq F(t) + \int_a^t F(s)G(s)e^{\int_s^t G(u)\mathrm{d}u}\mathrm{d}s$$

Theorem 12 (Differential Gronwall's Inequality)**.** *Let $u, K : [a, b] \to \mathbb{R}$ be respectively differentiable and continuous, and*

$$u'(t) \leq K(t)u(t), \quad \forall t \in [a, b]$$

then

$$u(t) \leq u(a)e^{\int_a^t K(s)\mathrm{d}s}$$

2.6.1 Proof 1

2.6.2 Proof 2

2.6.3 Proof 3

2.6.4 Proof 4

2.7 Maximal Solutions

Definition 10. *We call $f : A \to \mathbb{R}^n$ locally lipschitz if for every compact subset U of A it is lipschitz.*

Theorem 13. *Let $D \subset \mathbb{R}^n$ be a open and connected domain and $F : D \to \mathbb{R}^n$ locally lipschitz. Then there exists a unique maximal solution $x : I_{\max} \to D$ of*

$$x' = F(x(t)), x(0) = x_0 \in I_{\max}$$

where on a unique interval of existence $I_{\max} = (a, b)$ *where* $0 \in I_{\max}$*. In addition, if* $b < \infty$*,*

$$\lim_{x \to b} |x(t)| + \frac{1}{d(x(t), \partial D)}$$

2.8 Continuous Dependence

Theorem 14 (Continuous Dependence on Initial Conditions and Vector Fields)**.** *Let* $f : [a, b] \times \mathbb{R}^n \to \mathbb{R}^n$*, be Lipschitz in the Second variable with constant* $L \geq 0$*.*

Let $x_1, x_2 : [a, b] \to \mathbb{R}^n$*, assume*

$$\|x_1'(t) - f(t, x_1(t))\| < \varepsilon_1, \quad \|x_2'(t) - f(t, x_2(t))\| < \varepsilon_2$$

and initial values satisfy

$$\|x_1(a) - x_2(a)\| < \delta$$

then for all $t \in [a, b]$*,*

$$\|x_1(t) - x_2(t)\| < \delta e^{L(t-a)} + \frac{\varepsilon_1 + \varepsilon_2}{L}(e^{L(x-a)} - 1)$$

2.9 Autonomous ODE and Flow

Chapter 3

Planar Linear Systems of ODE's

3.1 Distinct Real Eigenvalues for a Planar System

Since a $2x2$ matrix has a two distinct real eigenvalues, we know that we diagonalize the matrix A into

$$D = CAC^{-1} = \begin{bmatrix} \lambda_1 & 0 \\ 0 & \lambda_2 \end{bmatrix}$$

which defines a eigen basis by C, of v_1 and v_2. Thus, it is clear that such an ODE

$$X' = AX(t)$$

must satisfy

$$x(t) = a(t)v_1 + b(t)v_2, \quad x'(t) = a(t)\lambda_1 v_1 + b(t)\lambda_2 v_2$$

which suggests the solution

$$x(t) = ae^{\lambda_1 t}v_1 + be^{\lambda_2 t}v_2$$

This defines two lines by setting $a = 0$ or $b = 0$, and the two directions

1. If $0 < \lambda_1 < \lambda_2$, then we see that along v_1 and v_2, the arrows points away from the origin to infinity.

2. If one is positive one is negative, arrows diverges from origin on the positive line, converges to origin on negative line.

3. If both are negative, both points to origin

3.2 Complex Eigenvalues for a Planar System

If the Eigenvalues are non-real, then we still have

3.3 Repeated Eigenvalues on a Planar System

Consider that you are given a homogeneous, autonomous, linear ODE:

$$x'(t) = Ax(t), \quad A \in \mathbb{R}^{2\times 2}$$

we seek a general solution to this, assuming the solution exist. But by our computation, it has the eigenvalue λ with algebrain multiplicity of 2 but geometric multiplicity of 1. We can no longer compute two linear independent eigenvectors to construct our solutions. Thus, we resort to the general eigenspace decomposition. Specifically, we can use Jordan Decomposition (for any dimentions).

In this case, we know there is a jordan decomposition of A into one jordan block, of the form

$$A = CJC^{-1}$$

where

$$J = J(\lambda, 2) = \begin{bmatrix} \lambda & 1 \\ 0 & \lambda \end{bmatrix}$$

where $v = Cv'C^{-1}$ is an eigenvector of A where v' is an eigenvector of J. Then to find the other basis vector for J we define

$$(A + \lambda I)u = v$$

as such a vector is guarenteed to exists by the jordan form. And thus

$$Au = v + \lambda u$$

Using v and u as a basis will simplify our later calculations.

We seek a solution of the form

$$x(t) = a(t)v + b(t)u$$

Since

$$Ax(t) = a(t)Av + b(t)Au = (\lambda a(t) + b(t))v + \lambda b(t)u$$

we have that

$$a'(t) = \lambda a(t) + b(t), \quad b'(t) = \lambda b(t)$$

then

$$b(t) = Be^{\lambda t}$$

Since

$$(e^{-\lambda t}a(t))' = b(t)e^{-\lambda t} = B, \quad a(t) = (A + tB)e^{\lambda t}$$

Then we have the final form of the solution:

$$x(t) = (A + tB)e^{\lambda t}v + Be^{\lambda t}u = e^{\lambda t}(Av + B(tv + u))$$

3.3.1 Qualitative Behaviors

1. If $\lambda > 0$
   (a) If $c_2 = 0$ then the solution stays on span v, moving away form the origin.
   (b) If $c_2 \neq 0$, then for large t, $x(t)$ is approximately $Be^{\lambda t}(tv + u)$ at time t, moving away from the origin.
2. If $\lambda < 0$, then the same thing above but towards the origin.

3.4 Determinant of the Matrix Exponential

Theorem 15 (Determinant of a Matrix Exponential)**.** *If B is a $n \times n$ matrix over C*

$$\det e^B = e^{\operatorname{tr} B}$$

Proof. Recall the definition of e^B:

$$e^B = \sum_{i=0}^{\infty} \frac{B^i}{i!}$$

We know that since B is a complex matrix, it has a jordan decomposition, providing

$$B = CJC^{-1}$$

where J is a diagonal matrix of square matrices:

$$J(\lambda, k)$$

where k is the size of the block. We treat the case of a single block:

$$J_i = \lambda I + N$$

where N is nilpotent. Recall that

$$\det e^{J_i} = \det e^{\lambda I} \det e^N$$

See that $e^N = \sum_{i=0}^k \frac{N^i}{i!}$ and since sums and products of a strictly upper triangular matrix N is also strictly triangular, the diagonal of e^N is only contributed by I. Thus, e^n is upper triangular and $\det e^N = \Pi_{i=1}^n 1 = 1$ Thus

$$\det e^{J_i} = \det e^{\lambda I} = \det((\sum_{i=0}^{\infty} \frac{\lambda^i}{i!})I) = \det e^{\lambda} = e^{\sum_{i=1}^k \lambda} = e^{\operatorname{tr} J(\lambda,k)}$$

The consider all the blocks, with n dimentional matrix B and jordan blocks J_i

$$\det e^B = \det e^J = \Pi_i \det J_i = e^{\operatorname{tr} B}$$

where we used that e^J is a identically partitioned block diagonal matrix with respect to J with the diagonal elements e^{J_i}.

□

Theorem 16 (Liouville's formula)**.** *Consider the Linear System*

$$x'(t) = A(t)x(t), \quad A(t) \in C([t_0, t_1], \mathbb{R}^{n\times n})$$

A fundamental matrix is a matrix-valued solution $\Phi(t)$ of

$$\Phi'(t) = A(t)\Phi(t), \quad \Phi(t_0) = B_0 \in \mathrm{GL}(n, \mathbb{R})$$

Then

$$\det \Phi(t) = \det(B_0) e^{\int_{t_0}^t \operatorname{tr}(A(s))\mathrm{d}s}$$

Equivalently, the Wrongskian $W(t) = \det \Phi$ satisfies the scalar ODE

$$W'(t) = \operatorname{tr}(A(t))W(t), \quad W(t_0) = \det B_0$$

(Assuming the solution exist and is unique)

Proof. We have that

$$(\Phi(t)' - A(t)\Phi(t))e^{-\int_{t_0}^t A(s)\mathrm{d}s} = 0$$

Thus

$$(\Phi(t)e^{-\int_{t_0}^t A(s)\mathrm{d}s})' = 0$$

and

$$\Phi(t) = B_0 e^{\int_{t_0}^t A(s)\mathrm{d}s}$$

and thus

$$\det \Phi(t) = \det B_0 e^{\operatorname{tr}\int_{t_0}^t A(s)\mathrm{d}s} = \det(B_0) e^{\int_{t_0}^t \operatorname{tr} A(s)\mathrm{d}s}$$

Then we have shown the first part. Now let $W(t) = \det \Phi(t)$.

$$W'(t) = \det(B_0) \operatorname{tr}(A(t)) e^{\int_{t_0}^t \operatorname{tr} A(s)\mathrm{d}s} = \operatorname{tr}(A(t))W(t)$$

□

3.5 Duhamel's Formula

Consider a inhomogeneous linear system:

$$x'(t) = Ax(t) + f(t)$$

where we take $A \in \mathbb{R}^{n\times n}$ and f is a time dependent function in $\mathbb{R}^n$. Let y be a *particular* solution to such a differential equation, then we know that, by linearity

$$x(t) = y(t) + e^{tA}v$$

is a solution for arbitary initial condition defining v. Indeed

$$x_1(t) = e^{At}v$$

is a solution to $x'(t) = Ax(t)$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} x'(t) &= (y + x_1)' \\ &= y' + x_1' \\ &= A(y + x_1) + f(t) \\ &= Ax + f(t) \end{aligned}$$

Thus, the problem reduces to finding a particular solution to the original system. Of course, we know very well the solution to the scalar ODE,

$$y' + P(t)y = Q(t)$$

where the solution is given using integration factor $e^{\int_{t_0}^t P(t)}$ by

$$\begin{aligned} e^{\int_{t_0}^t P(t)}y' + e^{\int_{t_0}^t P(t)}P(t)y &= Q(t)e^{\int_{t_0}^t P(t)} \\ (ye^{\int_{t_0}^t P(t)})' &= Q(t)e^{\int_{t_0}^t P(t)} \\ y(t) &= Ce^{-\int_{t_0}^t P(t)} + e^{-\int_{t_0}^t P(t)}\int_{t_0}^t Q(t)e^{\int_{t_0}^t P(t)} \end{aligned}$$